

NEXUS Hub

Work Instruction

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Owner: Quality Systems | Classification: Internal

Mastercard CQMAP V3.A Vendor Audit Management

NEXUS Hub — Work Instruction

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1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 Why This System Exists

The **NEXUS Hub** is our internal audit readiness tool. As a card manufacturing facility subject to periodic CQM audits under the Mastercard CQMAP V3.A framework, we use the NEXUS Hub to continuously track and improve our own compliance — so that when an external auditor arrives, we already know exactly where we stand.

The core idea is simple: **we run a continuous internal audit against ourselves using the same framework and criteria the external auditor will use.** Every finding we identify and close before the external audit is one fewer finding on the official record. Every CAPA we drive to closure is evidence that our quality system is self-correcting — which is itself a positive audit signal.

1.2 Our Role in the System

We are the manufacturing facility being assessed, not the auditor. This means:

- We fill in the **self-assessment** fields in the QMS Assessment (what we do, what evidence we have)
- We make **honest conformity self-ratings** — if we find a gap, we rate it nc- or NC+ on ourselves
- We manage our own **CAPA items** as internal corrective actions
- We maintain our own **document register** and **component supplier list** year-round
- The **external auditor** sets the final Grade and formally closes the audit record

The NEXUS Hub is our preparation infrastructure. We own the content; the auditor reviews it.

1.3 Scope

This work instruction applies to all Quality Engineering staff responsible for maintaining CQM audit readiness at our facility. It covers all product categories we manufacture (CB, ICC, P, ICM, IL as applicable).

2. Definitions and Terminology

Term	Definition
CQMAP V3.A	Mastercard Card Quality Management Assessment Program, version 3.A — the framework used for CQM audits
Audit Record	Our facility's digital compliance file in the NEXUS Hub — one record per audit cycle
Self-Assessment	Our internal evaluation of our own QMS against each CQMAP requirement, conducted before the external audit
Audit Cycle	The period between one external CQM audit and the next (6–24 months depending on grade)
QMS Assessment	The requirement-by-requirement conformity tracking table — the heart of our self-assessment
Requirement ID	A unique CQMAP requirement identifier (e.g., #0521# , #0583#)

Term	Definition
Conformity Rating	Our honest self-rating of how well we meet a requirement (see table below)
NC+	Major non-conformity — a significant gap requiring immediate corrective action; blocks Grade A/B
nc-	Minor non-conformity — a gap requiring corrective action within an agreed timeline
RI	Room for Improvement — an observation worth improving; no formal corrective action required
Full	Fully conforming — we have evidence that satisfies the requirement
NCC	Not currently certified — requirement is outside our current certification scope
Audit Grade	The overall quality rating assigned by the external CQM auditor: A (highest), B, C, or D
Gate #0706#	Six-condition qualification gate that must pass before a product can be ranked A, B, or C
CAPA	Corrective and Preventive Action — our documented response to any nc- or NC+ finding
CB	Card Body — the physical card substrate manufacturing process
ICC	Integrated Circuit Card — IC chip embedding and card assembly
P	Personalisation — card personalisation and fulfilment
ICM	IC Module — chip module preparation
IL	Inlay — antenna/inlay assembly for contactless cards

3. System Access

3.1 Logging In

Open a web browser and navigate to the CQM Quality Control Hub. Log in with your CQM username and password.

Permissions: Quality Engineers can create and edit audit records, self-assessment data, CAPAs, documents, and components. Read-only users can view the record but cannot modify data.

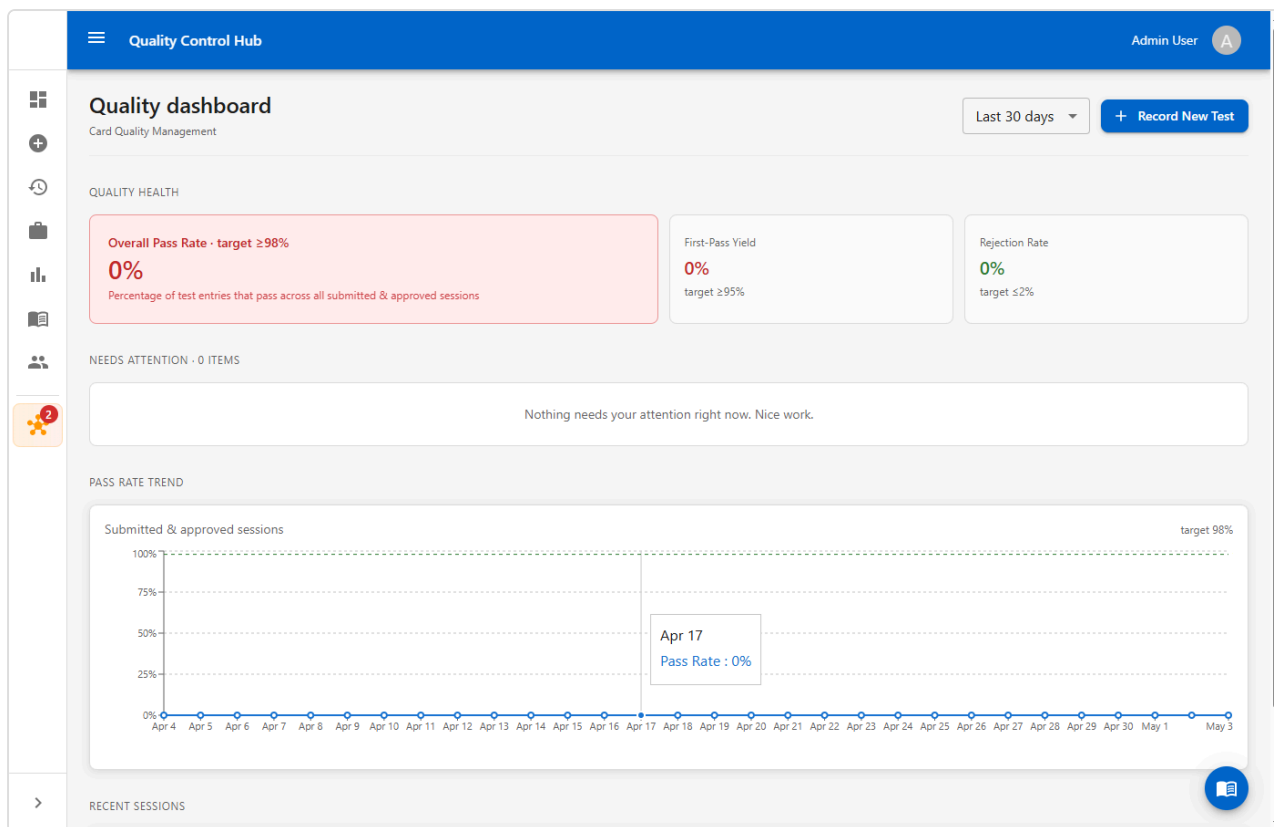


Figure 1 — CQM Quality Control Hub main dashboard

3.2 Navigating to NEXUS Hub

Click the **NEXUS Hub** button in the left sidebar (star/asterisk icon). If there are unread compliance alerts, a red badge shows the count.

4. NEXUS Hub Dashboard

The NEXUS Hub landing page shows the current status of our compliance programme at a glance.

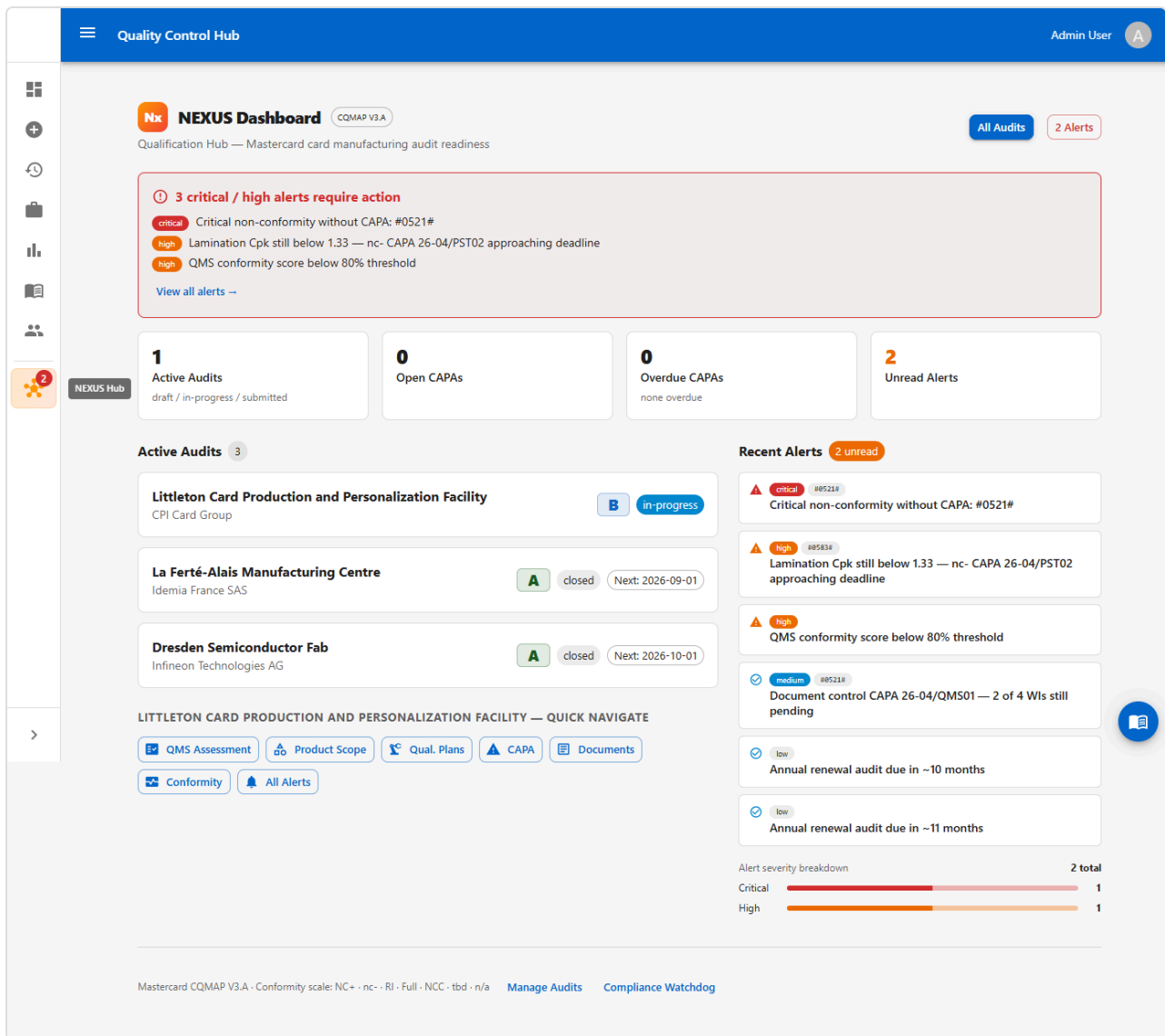


Figure 2 — NEXUS Hub dashboard showing audit cycle status, KPI tiles, and active alerts

4.1 KPI Tiles

Tile	What it tells us
Active Audits	Audit records currently in Draft or In-Progress — typically just our current cycle record
Open CAPAs	Internal corrective actions not yet closed — our to-do list
Overdue CAPAs	CAPAs past their self-assigned deadline — requires immediate attention
Unread Alerts	Compliance alerts not yet reviewed

4.2 Our Audit Record Card

Our facility's audit record appears as a card showing the site name, current status, grade from the last external audit, and next scheduled audit date. Click it to open the full record.

4.3 Alerts Panel

Recent unread compliance alerts are shown on the right. Click **View all alerts** → for the full list. Alerts are our early-warning system — see Section 13.

5. Creating Your Audit Record

A new audit record is created at the start of each audit cycle — typically shortly after the previous external audit closes, or when preparing for a first audit.

5.1 Opening the Form

From the NEXUS Hub dashboard, click **+ New Audit**.

The screenshot shows the NEXUS Hub dashboard with a 'New Audit Record' form overlay. The dashboard header includes a menu icon, 'Quality Control Hub', and 'Admin User' with a profile icon. A sidebar on the left contains various icons, including a red badge with the number '2'. The main content area features a 'Critical compliance issues require immediate attention' alert with '1 Critical' and '1 High' indicators, and a 'View all 2 alerts' button. Below this is an 'Audit Records' section with the text 'Each record mirrors the Mastercard CQ'. The 'New Audit Record' form overlay contains the following fields: 'Site Name *', 'Site Code', 'Company *', 'Address', 'Country', 'Auditor Name', 'Auditor Company', 'Audit Start' (mm/dd/yyyy), 'Audit End' (mm/dd/yyyy), an 'ISO 9001 Certified' toggle switch (currently off) with the text '60 QMS requirements will be seeded (full checklist for non-certified sites)', and a 'Notes' text area. At the bottom right of the form are 'Cancel' and 'Create' buttons.

Figure 3 — New Audit Record creation form

5.2 Completing the Coversheet

Field	What to enter
Site Name	The formal name of our manufacturing facility
Company	Our legal entity name
Address	Full postal address of the facility
Country	Country where the facility is located

Field	What to enter
Site Code	Our CQM-assigned site identifier
Auditor Name	Leave blank until the external auditor is confirmed; fill in when known
Auditor Company	Leave blank until confirmed
Audit Start Date	Planned or confirmed start date of the upcoming external audit
Audit End Date	Planned or confirmed end date
ISO 9001 Certified	Toggle ON if our facility holds a current ISO 9001 certificate
Notes	Any relevant context about this audit cycle (scope changes, new product lines, etc.)

5.3 ISO 9001 Toggle and Requirement Set

The **ISO 9001 Certified** toggle determines which CQMAP requirements are loaded into our QMS Assessment:

- **Toggle ON** — Full requirement set including ISO 9001-mapped clauses (~31 requirements)
- **Toggle OFF** — Non-ISO subset of CQMAP requirements

Important: The requirement set is seeded when the record is saved and cannot be changed after creation. Confirm ISO certification status before saving.

5.4 Saving the Record

Click **Create Audit Record**. The system creates the record in Draft status and automatically populates the QMS Assessment with all applicable requirements. We are ready to begin self-assessment.

6. Audit Detail — Overview Tab

Every audit record opens on the Overview tab. The tab bar across the top gives access to all sections.

Quality Control Hub

Admin User

Critical compliance issues require immediate attention
1 Critical 1 High
Critical non-conformity without CAPA: #0521# — Requirement #0521# (Creating and updating documented information) is rated NC+ but has no Corrective Action Plan item.
View all 2 alerts

All AuditsLittleton Card Production and Personalization FacilityIn-ProgressB 18moExport PDF

OVERVIEWQMS ASSESSMENTPRODUCT SCOPECAPAQALIFICATION PLANSDOCUMENTSCOMPONENTS

Coversheet Details

Site Name
Littleton Card Production and Personalization Facility

Site Code

Company
CPI Card Group

Country

Auditor Name

Auditor Company

Audit Start
04/07/2026

Audit End
04/09/2026

Status
in-progress

Audit Grade
Grade B

Notes

QMS Assessment →Product Scope →CAPA →Qualification Plans →Documents →Components →

AI Readiness CheckClaude analyses QMS score, open CAPAs, and overdue items to rate audit readiness.Run AI Readiness Check

Figure 4 — Audit detail overview showing the tab bar, coversheet, and status fields

6.1 Tab Navigation

Tab	What we use it for
Overview	Coversheet, status, grade tracking, AI Readiness Check
QMS Assessment	Our continuous self-assessment against all CQMAP requirements
Product Scope	Our manufacturing processes and process step conformity
CAPA	Our internal corrective action tracker
Qualification Plans	Product qualification plans and Gate #0706# evidence
Documents	Our controlled document register linked to requirements
Components	Our component supplier and subcontractor list

6.2 Status — Tracking Where We Are in the Cycle

We control the status field throughout the year. Set it to reflect the true state of our record:

Status	When we set it
Draft	Record just created; initial data entry in progress
In-Progress	Active self-assessment underway — the normal working state for most of the cycle
Submitted	We have completed our preparation and submitted the record for external review
Closed	External audit complete; grade confirmed. We then open a new record for the next cycle

6.3 Grade Field

The **Audit Grade** (A, B, C, or D) is set by the **external CQM auditor** after the audit visit — not by us. We can see and track it, but we do not assign it ourselves. The grade drives the next audit interval (see Section 15).

6.4 Compliance Alert Banner

If the system has detected critical issues — an NC+ self-rating without a CAPA, an overdue corrective action — a red banner appears at the top of the page. This is our signal to act before the situation worsens. Click **View all alerts** to see the full list.

6.5 Quick-Navigation Buttons

At the bottom of the Overview tab, shortcut buttons go directly to each other section: **QMS Assessment** →, **Product Scope** →, **CAPA** →, **Qualification Plans** →, **Documents** →, **Components** →.

7. QMS Assessment Tab — Self-Assessment

The QMS Assessment tab is the core of our compliance work. This is where we evaluate ourselves against every CQMAP requirement, honestly and regularly.

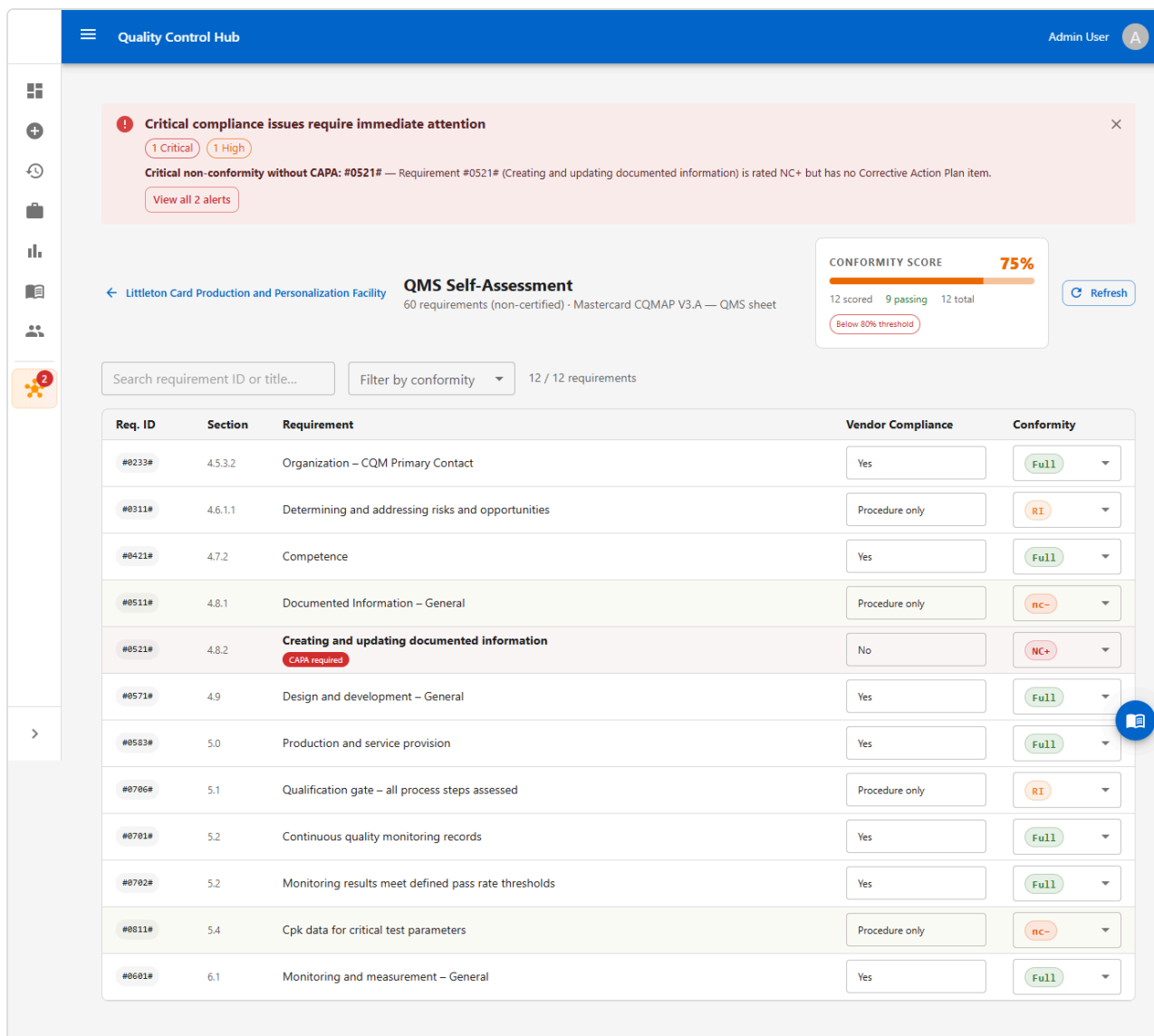


Figure 5 — QMS Assessment tab showing self-assessed conformity ratings, evidence references, and CAPA indicators

7.1 The Self-Assessment Mindset

We approach this tab the same way an external auditor would: for each requirement, we ask "Do we actually meet this? What evidence do we have? If an auditor asked us to demonstrate this right now, could we?" If the honest answer is no — or not fully — we rate it accordingly. A gap we find and fix ourselves is far better than one the auditor finds.

7.2 Assessment Grid Columns

Column	Our responsibility
Req. ID	CQMAP identifier — read-only, seeded automatically
Section	CQMAP section number — read-only
Title	Requirement description — read-only

Column	Our responsibility
ISO 9001	Whether this maps to an ISO 9001 clause — informational
Vendor Compliance	We fill this — describe how we comply (e.g., "Procedure QP-007 Rev 3 in place")
Evidence Ref	We fill this — the document, record, or system reference that proves compliance
Conformity	Our honest self-rating — see Section 7.3
Auditor Comment	Left blank during self-assessment; the external auditor may add comments here

7.3 Setting Our Conformity Self-Rating

For each requirement, select the rating that honestly reflects our current position:

Rating	When to use it
tbd	Not yet self-assessed — the default; work through these systematically
Full	We fully comply; evidence is current, controlled, and readily available
RI	We comply but there is room to improve; no formal finding needed
nc-	We have a minor gap — a CAPA is automatically created for us to track resolution
NC+	We have a significant gap — a CAPA is automatically created; this blocks Grade A/B
NCC	This requirement is outside our current certification scope
n/a	This requirement genuinely does not apply to our facility or processes

When in doubt, rate lower. It is far better to self-identify an nc- and drive it to closure before the external audit than to rate it Full and have the auditor disagree. An honest self-assessment with resolved CAPAs is one of the strongest signals of a mature quality system.

7.4 Auto-CAPA Creation

When we set a rating to **nc-** or **NC+**, the system automatically creates a CAPA entry in the CAPA tab. We must then navigate to the CAPA tab to:

- Write a clear, specific observation describing the gap
- Set a realistic deadline for resolution
- Assign responsibility

7.5 Conformity Score

The header shows a live score — the percentage of assessed requirements rated Full or RI. This is the number the external auditor will use as a baseline. Our target before the external audit:

Target Grade	Conformity Score to Aim For
A	≥ 90%
B	≥ 80%
C	≥ 70%

7.6 Keeping the Assessment Current

The QMS Assessment is not a once-a-year exercise. Whenever we update a procedure, complete a CAPA, add new evidence, or change a process, we update the relevant row. The assessment should reflect our *current* position at all times.

8. Product Scope & Process Steps Tab

This tab defines what we manufacture and tracks our self-assessed conformity for each step of our manufacturing process.

Quality Control Hub Admin User

Critical compliance issues require immediate attention
 1 Critical 1 High
 Critical non-conformity without CAPA: #0521# — Requirement #0521# (Creating and updating documented information) is rated NC+ but has no Corrective Action Plan item.
 View all 2 alerts

Product Scope & Process Steps
 Select in-scope product types and assess conformity across all process steps. NC+/nc- ratings auto-create CAPA items.

Add product category + Add & Seed Steps Process steps will be auto-seeded from the CQMAP V3.A process step library.

ICC — IC Card In Scope Rank B

11 process steps 9 Full 1 NC findings

Tag	Process Step	Conformity	Vendor Site
#3003#	Thickness outside Contacts and Add-on Areas	Full	CPI Littleton CO
#3054#	3 Wheel Test Robustness [ISO 10373-1]	Full	CPI Littleton CO
#3058#	Adhesion of ICM to Card	Full	CPI Littleton CO
#3061#	Verification of Antenna Functionality (ATS)	Full	CPI Littleton CO
#A00#	IQC – Incoming Quality Control	Full	CPI Littleton CO
#G40#	Lamination	nc-	CPI Littleton CO
#T10#	ICM Protection (Protective Lamination)	Full	CPI Littleton CO

P — Personalisation In Scope Rank B

Figure 6 — Product Scope tab showing our manufacturing categories with process steps and conformity ratings

8.1 Setting Up Our Product Scope

When the audit record is first created:

1. Click **Add product category**
2. Select each category that applies to our facility (CB, ICC, P, ICM, IL)
3. Click + **Add & Seed Steps**

The system loads all CQMAP V3.A process steps for that category. Only add categories we actually perform — do not add categories that are out of scope for our facility.

8.2 Assessing Our Process Steps

For each process step, we walk our own floor and ask: does our process meet this standard?

1. Set the **Conformity** rating (same scale as the QMS Assessment)
2. Enter the **Vendor Site** field as our own facility name
3. If we rate a step nc- or NC+, the system creates a CAPA — complete it immediately with the specific gap and a deadline

This is our internal process audit. Do it honestly. Steps that we rate nc- and then close before the external audit demonstrate exactly the kind of self-correcting quality system that earns a Grade A.

8.3 Keeping Steps Current

When we change a process, qualify a new step, or close a related CAPA, update the process step conformity. The Product Scope tab should reflect the current state of our production floor.

8.4 Product Rank

Each product category has a Rank field (A, B, C, or D). The external auditor sets this based on our self-assessment, process step conformity, and Gate #0706# status. We track it here but do not assign it ourselves.

Gate #0706# Requirement: A product cannot be ranked A, B, or C until all six Gate #0706# conditions pass. See Section 10 for the full gate checklist.

9. CAPA — Internal Corrective Action Tracking

The CAPA tab is our internal corrective action and non-conformance management log. It captures every gap we identify — whether through self-assessment, process monitoring, customer feedback, or internal audit.

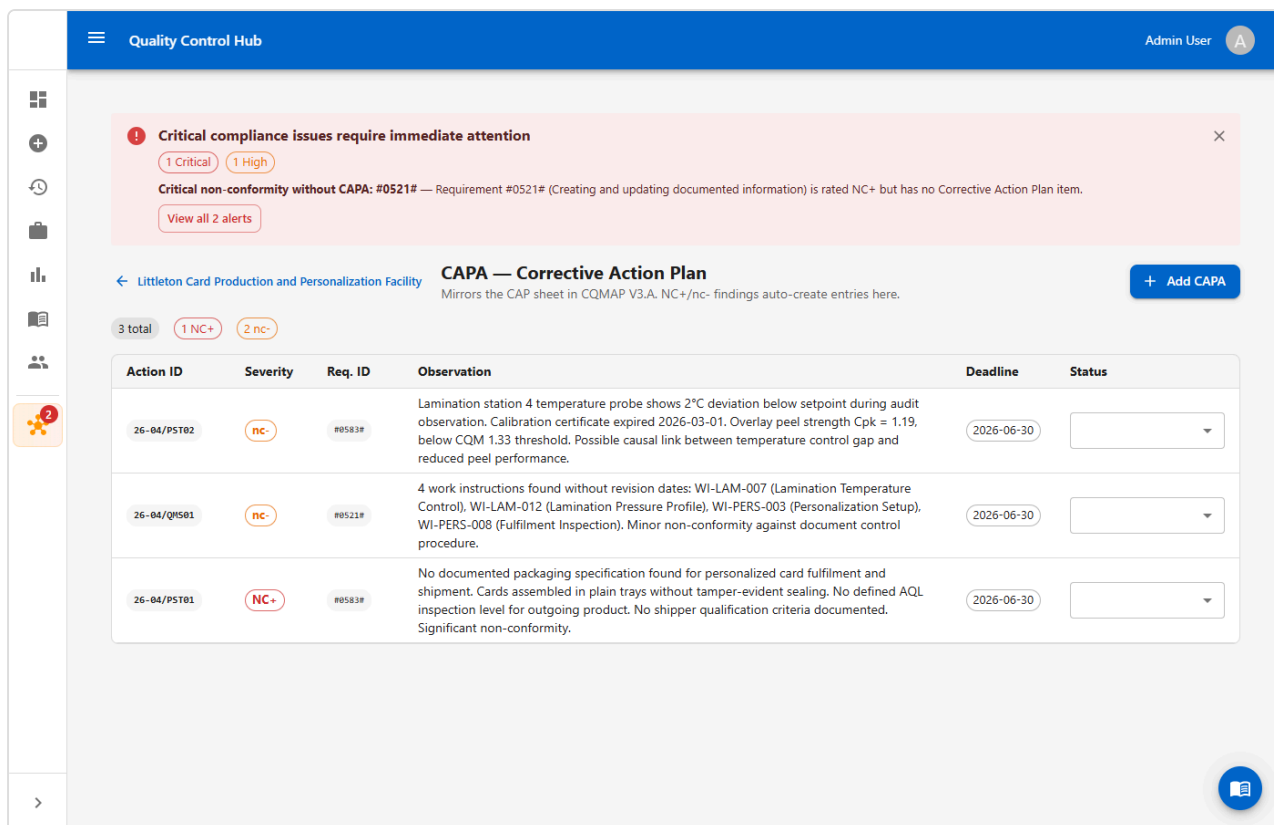


Figure 7 — CAPA tab showing active corrective actions with severity, observation, deadline, and status

9.1 How CAPAs Are Created

CAPAs are created two ways:

- **Automatically** — when we rate a QMS requirement or process step as nc- or NC+ in the self-assessment
- **Manually** — by clicking **+ Add CAPA** for any gap we identify that falls outside a specific requirement (e.g., a process observation from an internal walk-through, a customer complaint, a near-miss)

Both are valid and encouraged. The CAPA log should capture everything we know about our own gaps.

9.2 CAPA Entry Fields

Field	What to enter
Action ID	Auto-generated (e.g., 26-04/PST01) — do not edit
Severity	NC+ or nc- — inherited from the triggering rating, or set manually for manual CAPAs
Req. ID	The CQMAP requirement or process step tag (e.g., #0583#)
Observation	Write a clear, specific description of the gap — what is missing, what evidence is lacking, what was observed. Be specific enough that someone unfamiliar with the issue understands exactly what the problem is
Deadline	Set a realistic date by which we will close the CAPA. Be honest — an overdue CAPA is worse than a longer deadline

Field	What to enter
Status	Track progress honestly through the workflow

9.3 CAPA Status Workflow

Move each CAPA through the following stages as work progresses:

Status	When to set it
Not yet started	CAPA created; no action taken yet
In progress	We are actively working on the corrective action
Under Review	Corrective action is complete; we are verifying effectiveness
Awaiting Auditor	We believe it is resolved and are ready for external verification
Closed	Confirmed resolved — either by ourselves (for nc-) or the external auditor (for NC+)

9.4 The NC+ Without CAPA Alert

If any requirement is rated NC+ but has no CAPA, the system raises a **Critical** alert and displays a red banner throughout the audit record. This is never acceptable — every NC+ must have a CAPA. Address this immediately by either adding the CAPA or reconsidering the rating.

9.5 CAPA as Evidence

A well-managed CAPA log is one of the most valuable things we can show an external auditor. It demonstrates:

- We find our own problems (self-awareness)
- We document them formally (process discipline)
- We close them within committed timelines (execution)
- We verify the fix worked (effectiveness)

Aim to have no open NC+ CAPAs and all nc- CAPAs in progress or closed before the external audit.

10. Qualification Plans Tab

The Qualification Plans tab manages our product qualification plans and tracks the Gate #0706# evidence for each product we manufacture.

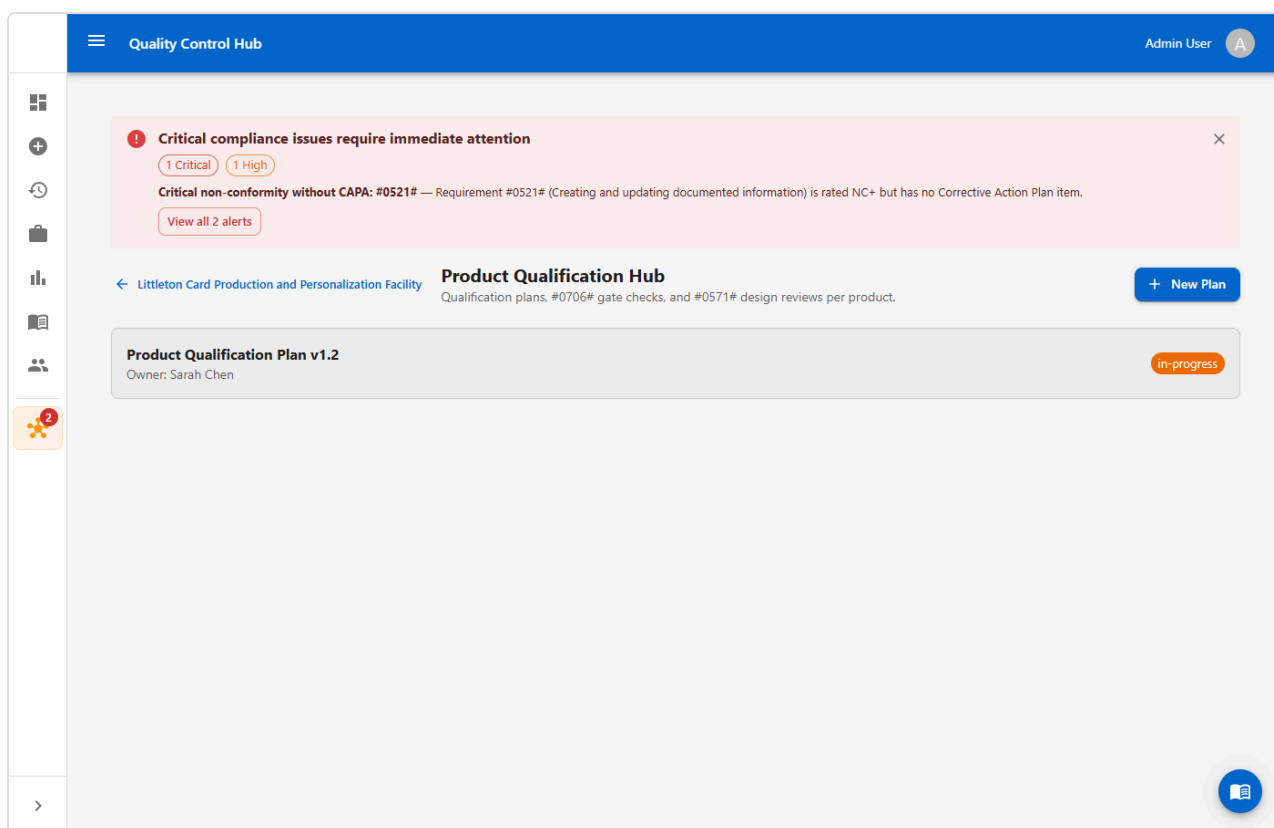


Figure 8 — Qualification Plans showing a plan in-progress with owner and status

10.1 Creating a Qualification Plan

Click + **New Plan** and complete:

- **Plan Name** — e.g., "Credit Card Qualification Plan v1.2"
- **Owner** — the Quality Engineer responsible for driving this plan
- **Status** — Draft, In-Progress, or Complete

10.2 Gate #0706# — The Six Conditions

Before any product can be ranked A, B, or C in Product Scope, all six gate conditions must be satisfied. We track evidence for each:

#	Gate Condition	Evidence Type
1	All process steps assessed	Completed process step assessment in Product Scope tab
2	Continuous quality monitoring records available	Test session records in the CQM system
3	Monitoring results meet defined pass rate thresholds	Test session pass rate data
4	SPC evidence — control charts and Cpk ≥ 1.33 for critical parameters	SPC reports
5	Cpk data available for critical test parameters	Capability study data

#	Gate Condition	Evidence Type
6	Intermediate and final design reviews completed and signed off	Design review records

When all six are satisfied, the gate passes and the external auditor can assign a rank of A, B, or C to that product.

11. Document Register Tab

The Document Register is our controlled document list linked to CQMAP requirements. It is the digital equivalent of maintaining a live document evidence portfolio.

Figure 9 — Document Register showing evidence documents linked to CQMAP requirements

11.1 What to Register

For each CQMAP requirement we rate as Full or RI, there should be at least one entry in the Document Register that evidences that rating. Common document types:

Requirement area	Typical evidence
Document control	Document Control Procedure, master document list
Calibration	Calibration register, calibration certificates

Requirement area	Typical evidence
Training	Training records, competency matrix
Work instructions	Controlled SOPs/WIs for each process step
Non-conformance	CAPA procedure, NCR log
Internal audit	Internal audit schedule, reports

11.2 Adding a Document

Click **+ Add Document** and complete the row:

Field	What to enter
Doc ID	Our internal document reference number (e.g., QP-007 , WI-LAM-003)
Req. ID	The CQMAP requirement this document evidences
Title	Full document title
Type	Procedure, Work Instruction, Record, Certificate, Register, etc.
Version	Current revision
Notes	Any relevant notes — e.g., "Under revision", "Renewal due Q3 2026", "Submitted to auditor"

11.3 Identifying and Addressing Document Gaps

If a requirement is rated Full but no corresponding document is registered, we have an evidence gap. Use the Notes field to flag it: **MISSING – [reason]** . This signals to the team that a document needs to be created or located before the audit.

Document gaps that represent real compliance shortfalls should be reflected as nc- or RI in the QMS Assessment and driven through CAPA.

11.4 Keeping It Current

Review the Document Register at least quarterly and before the external audit. For every document, verify:

- The version number is current
- The document is formally controlled (approved, dated, revision-controlled)
- The document is accessible and ready to present

12. Components Registry Tab

The Components Registry lists all external suppliers and subcontractors whose materials or sub-assemblies go into our card products. This mirrors the Components sheet of CQMAP V3.A.

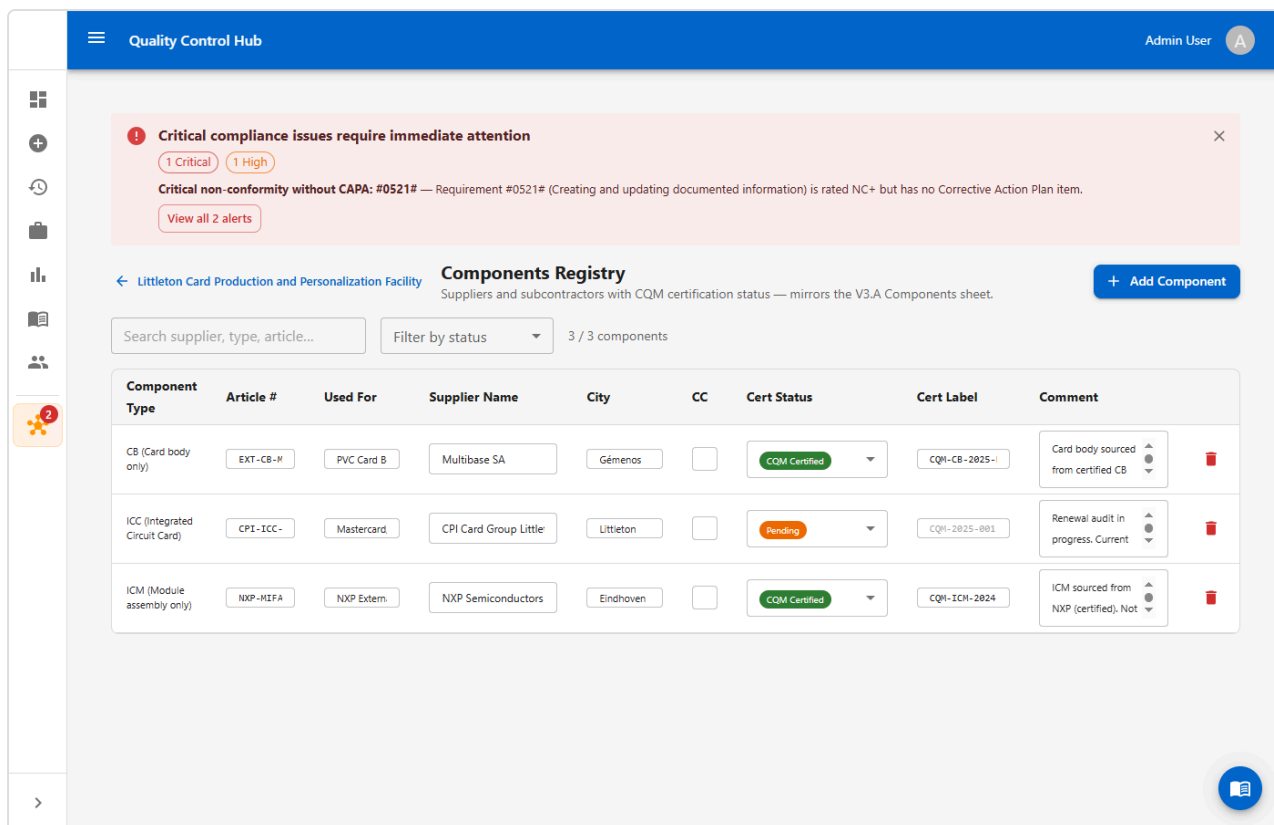


Figure 10 — Components Registry showing our component suppliers with CQM certification status

12.1 What to Register

Register every external component supplier whose material becomes part of our finished card product. This includes:

- Card body (PVC, polycarbonate) suppliers
- IC module suppliers
- Inlay/antenna suppliers
- Overlay/laminate suppliers
- Any sub-contracted processing (e.g., a third-party personalisation bureau)

12.2 Component Entry Fields

Field	What to enter
Component Type	CB, ICC, ICM, IL, or P — the product category this component feeds
Article #	Supplier's article or part number
Used For	What our product uses this component for
Supplier Name	Full company name
City	Supplier's city
Cert Status	CQM Certified, Pending, Not Certified, or Exempt
Cert Label	Supplier's CQM certificate reference number

Field	What to enter
Comment	Renewal dates, qualifications in progress, notes

12.3 Certification Status

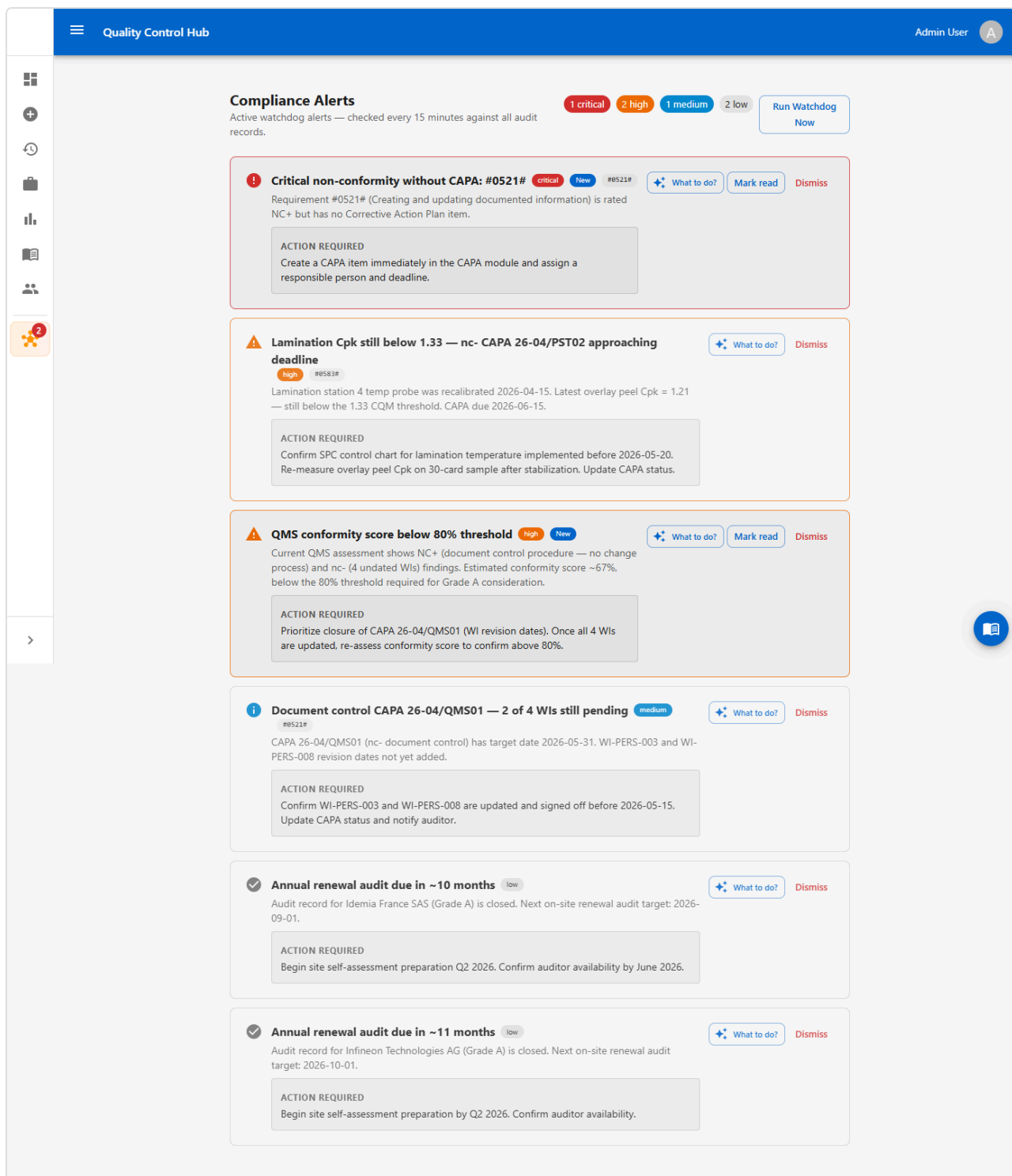
Status	Meaning and our action
CQM Certified	Supplier holds a current certificate — no action needed unless renewal is approaching
Pending	Certification in progress — track progress and update when issued
Not Certified	Not CQM certified — flag for review; may require qualification or alternative sourcing
Exempt	Formally exempted — document the basis for exemption in Comments

12.4 Keeping It Current

Update the Components Registry whenever we qualify a new supplier, receive a supplier's renewed certificate, or make a component change. An outdated registry is an audit finding waiting to happen.

13. Compliance Alerts

The Compliance Alerts page is our automated compliance watchdog. It runs every 15 minutes and checks all our data against key compliance rules, surfacing issues before they become audit findings.



13.1 Alert Severity Levels

Severity	What it means for us
Medium	A CAPA is partially overdue or document gaps have been flagged. Address within the week
Low	Our renewal audit is approaching (~10–12 months out). Begin preparation planning

13.2 Acting on Alerts

Each alert has an **ACTION REQUIRED** panel that tells us exactly what to do. Click **What to do?** to expand it.

Button	When to use it
What to do?	Expands the guided action panel — always read this first
Mark read	Acknowledge the alert; it remains visible but no longer counts as unread
Dismiss	Dismiss the alert if the condition has been resolved or is no longer applicable

13.3 Using Alerts as a Work Queue

Review the Alerts page at the start of each week. Treat unread critical and high alerts as immediate action items. Treat medium alerts as the current week's work queue. Low alerts are planning inputs.

The unread alert count on the NEXUS Hub sidebar button is our health indicator — aim to keep it at zero.

13.4 Run Watchdog Now

After resolving a CAPA or updating a conformity rating, click **Run Watchdog Now** to force an immediate re-check. Confirm that the alert clears before considering the item closed.

14. AI Readiness Check

The AI Readiness Check is an on-demand analysis available from the Overview tab. It reads our live audit record data and produces a written readiness assessment.

14.1 What It Analyses

- Our current QMS conformity score and what is driving it down
- Open and overdue CAPAs and their risk to the upcoming audit
- Product scope rank eligibility against Gate #0706#
- Key risks to achieving or maintaining our target grade

14.2 Running the Check

From the Overview tab, click **Run AI Readiness Check**. The report appears within a few seconds. It is advisory — it does not change any data in the record.

14.3 When to Run It

Timing	Purpose
6 months before the external audit	Identify major gaps while there is still time to address them
3 months before	Check progress; confirm preparation is on track
4–6 weeks before	Final readiness check; identify any remaining open items
After closing a major CAPA	Confirm the improvement is reflected in the score

15. Audit Grade and Scheduling Logic

15.1 Grade Criteria

The external auditor assigns our grade based on their review of our self-assessment, process step findings, and CAPA status. The grade criteria the auditor uses:

Grade	QMS Conformity	NC+ Findings	CAPA Health
A	≥ 90% Full/RI	None	All closed
B	≥ 80% Full/RI	None open	All nc- within deadline
C	≥ 70% Full/RI	Resolved or mitigated	Tracked with plans
D	Below 70% or systemic gaps	May be present	Must be initiated

These thresholds are our targets for self-assessment. If our self-rated score is below our target grade threshold, we know we have work to do before the audit.

15.2 Next Audit Date

Once the external auditor sets our grade and closes the record, the system calculates our next audit date automatically:

Grade Achieved	Next Audit In
A	24 months
B	18 months
C	12 months
D	6 months

Achieving Grade A gives us the longest cycle — two full years. This is why maintaining strong self-assessment discipline throughout the cycle pays off.

16. Continuous Audit Readiness — The Annual Cycle

Unlike a vendor managed by someone else, we own our audit record from start to finish. The goal is that our NEXUS Hub record is never more than a few weeks out of date — so at any point in the cycle, we could hand it to an auditor and be confident it reflects reality.

16.1 Opening a New Audit Cycle

Immediately after an external audit closes, open a new audit record for the next cycle:

1. Create the record with the next planned audit dates (even if provisional)
2. Set status to **In-Progress**
3. Roll forward any unresolved items from the previous cycle into new CAPAs
4. Begin updating the QMS Assessment to reflect the current state

16.2 Ongoing Maintenance (Throughout the Year)

Monthly:

- Review open CAPAs — update status, escalate anything drifting past deadline
- Check the Alerts page — address all critical and high alerts
- Update the Document Register when documents are revised or renewed
- Update process step conformity if any process changes occurred

Quarterly:

- Run a full review of the QMS Assessment — update Vendor Compliance, Evidence Ref, and Conformity for any requirement where something has changed
- Update the Components Registry for any supplier changes or certificate renewals
- Run the AI Readiness Check to sense-check our overall position

16.3 Pre-Audit Preparation (3–6 Months Before)

1. **Run the AI Readiness Check** — identify all gaps, prioritise by severity and effort
2. **Drive all NC+ CAPAs to Closed** — no NC+ findings should be open when the auditor arrives
3. **Progress all nc- CAPAs** — aim for Closed or at minimum Under Review
4. **Review every tbd in the QMS Assessment** — every row must have a rating before the external audit
5. **Audit the Document Register** — verify every registered document is current, controlled, and accessible
6. **Verify Gate #0706# conditions** — confirm all six conditions are met for every product we want ranked A/B/C
7. **Update the Components Registry** — confirm certification status for all suppliers
8. **Set status to Submitted** when preparation is complete

16.4 During the External Audit

- Share the NEXUS Hub record with the external auditor as the primary evidence package

- The auditor reviews our self-assessment, verifies evidence, and may adjust conformity ratings based on their findings
- Any new findings the auditor identifies will be added as NC+ or nc- and auto-generate CAPAs
- After the visit, the auditor sets the final Grade and transitions the record to **Closed**

16.5 After the External Audit

- Review any adjustments the auditor made to our conformity ratings — these are areas where our self-assessment needs recalibration
- Ensure all CAPA items raised by the auditor have clear owners and deadlines
- Open the next cycle audit record (Section 16.1)
- Note the new next-audit date — set a calendar reminder for the 6-month preparation start

16.6 Grade A Audit — What It Looks Like

The following shows an example of a closed Grade A audit record. The conformity score was high, no NC+ findings were present, all CAPAs were closed, and the facility is rewarded with a 24-month renewal interval.

The screenshot displays the 'Quality Control Hub' interface. At the top, a blue header bar contains a menu icon, the text 'Quality Control Hub', and a user profile 'Admin User' with a circular icon. A left sidebar shows various navigation icons, including a red badge with the number '2'. The main content area features a prominent red alert box at the top stating: 'Critical compliance issues require immediate attention' with '1 Critical' and '1 High' indicators, and a sub-message: 'Annual renewal audit due in ~10 months — Audit record for Idemia France SAS (Grade A) is closed. Next on-site renewal audit target: 2026-09-01.' Below this, a button says 'View all 2 alerts'. The main record is for 'La Ferté-Alais Manufacturing Centre' (Idemia France SAS), marked as 'Closed' with a green 'A 24mo' badge and an 'Export PDF' button. A tabbed interface shows 'OVERVIEW' selected, with other tabs for 'QMS ASSESSMENT', 'PRODUCT SCOPE', 'CAPA', 'QUALIFICATION PLANS', 'DOCUMENTS', and 'COMPONENTS'. The 'Coversheet Details' section includes fields for Site Name ('La Ferté-Alais Manufacturing Centre'), Site Code, Company ('Idemia France SAS'), Country, Auditor Name, Auditor Company, Audit Start ('09/22/2025'), Audit End ('09/24/2025'), Status (dropdown), Audit Grade ('Grade A'), and Next audit ('2026-09-01'). A 'Notes' text area is at the bottom. Below the coversheet are buttons for 'QMS Assessment', 'Product Scope', 'CAPA', 'Qualification Plans', 'Documents', and 'Components'. At the very bottom, an 'AI Readiness Check' section states 'Claude analyses QMS score, open CAPAs, and overdue items to rate audit readiness.' with a 'Run AI Readiness Check' button.

Figure 12 — Example of a closed Grade A audit record showing the 24-month renewal cycle

This is our target state at the close of every external audit — a clean record, all findings resolved, and the longest possible time before the next scheduled audit.

End of Work Instruction WI-NEXUS-001 Rev 2.0
For questions or updates, contact the Quality Systems team.